

JONAH'S WEB STRATEGY

How to prompt Claude to build scroll-cinema websites -
the single-clip, scroll-scrubbed product films behind
EMBER, OSCILLA, VANTA, RIFT and MERIDIAN. Bare bones.

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Instagram / build inquiries

EDITION 1.0

2026

A repeatable system, not a one-off. Made with Claude Code.

START HERE

WHAT YOU'RE ACTUALLY BUILDING

One product or one scene that never leaves the screen. As the visitor scrolls, it moves - deconstructs, reassembles, orbits, zooms, takes off, lands - locked frame-for-frame to the scrollbar. Scroll down, it advances; scroll up, it rewinds. Editorial copy floats over the top.

It is NOT a video on a timer and it is NOT CSS moving PNGs. It is a short cinematic clip, rendered once, decoded into an image sequence that a canvas paints in lock-step with scroll. The page feels like the camera. That is the whole trick, and it reads as expensive.

Why it goes viral / sells

Most sites scroll past content. These make the scroll BE the content - the motion is the product reveal. It stops the thumb. Five live examples already exist in one codebase, each a different product on the same engine:

SITE	PRODUCT	SIGNATURE
EMBER	Red-berry drink	Crimson, Anton type
OSCILLA	Skeleton tourbillon watch	Titanium, the watch opens
VANTA	Matte-black hypercar	Champagne, car deconstructs
RIFT	Concept hype sneaker	Volt-green, full drop page
MERIDIAN	Private-jet charter	Night->day flight journey

The strategy in one line: pick a hero object, render a clip of it doing one beautiful thing, and let scroll drive it. Everything below is how you get Claude to build that for you, start to finish.

THE MENTAL MODEL

You do not need to write the engine - it already exists and Claude copies it. But you must understand it, or your asset prompts will fight it.

- 1 A short clip is played once, invisibly. Every frame is captured (requestVideoFrameCallback -> WebP blob -> Image) and stored. Scroll then paints the right frame to a full-screen canvas. Decode-free, refresh-rate smooth.
- 2 Frames persist in the browser (IndexedDB), so the second visit is instant.
- 3 The timeline is a list of segments: { url, url4K, reverse, span }. Scroll progress 0->1 is split across segments by their span weights.
- 4 A reversed clip is FREE - it replays an existing clip's frames backward. Use it for reassembly and zoom-back-out reveals without generating anything.
- 5 Desktop scrubs a 4K master; phones scrub a 1080p source so they don't run out of memory decoding 4K.

The one rule that makes it smooth

Never scrub with `video.currentTime` - that is decode-bound and turns into a slideshow. Always capture frames first, then paint. If a build ever looks like a slideshow, this rule was broken.

WHAT YOU NEED BEFORE YOU PROMPT

YOU NEED	WHY
Claude Code on this repo	It reads CLAUDE.md and copies the closest finished site.
A Higgsfield account	You generate the images/videos yourself (Nano Banana, Kling 3.0, Topaz).
A branch to work on	Claude commits + pushes here; it does not create new branches.
A concept + a name	One hero object/scene. Claude proposes name/route/color; you veto.

The three files that add a site (nothing else moves)

- app/<name>/page.tsx - the page (engine + sections).
- middleware.ts - one line in SUBDOMAIN_ROUTES: '<sub>': '/<name>'.
- components/app-wrapper.tsx - one line in the allowlist so it runs bare (no marketing navbar/loader).

Each site also gets its OWN copy of the engine - components/<name>/frame-stage.tsx and lib/<name>-assets.ts - so sites never interfere. Tell Claude to copy RIFT; it is the cleanest, most complete example.

STEP BY STEP: PROMPTING CLAUDE

This is the exact loop used to build MERIDIAN. Follow it in order.

1

Kick it off with the master prompt

- Paste the kickoff prompt (next page). It tells Claude to read CLAUDE.md, stay on your branch, copy the closest site, and not touch existing routes.

2

Lock the brief

- Claude proposes a brand name, /route, subdomain key, accent color and font.
- You approve or veto. (That is how VANTA, OSCILLA, EMBER, RIFT, MERIDIAN got named.)

3

Let it scaffold with empty asset slots

- Claude creates components/<name>/, lib/<name>-assets.ts with empty string URLs, the page, and the two one-line edits. Empty slots are skipped, so it builds green at every stage.

4

Generate assets from Claude's recipes

- Claude gives you exact Higgsfield recipes. YOU generate them in the app (the generate tools need an approval widget Claude cannot trigger).
- Claude CAN pull your keepers, upscale them (Topaz 4K), and wire them in.

5

Go clip by clip, chain as you go

- Each clip starts on the previous clip's last frame -> no cuts. Send Claude each keeper; it upscales + wires + gives you the next recipe.
- When something looks wrong ('the plane spawns in'), tell Claude plainly; it rewrites the prompt and frames to fix it.

6

Build + push after every change

- npm run build must pass, then commit + push. The site is presentable at every step because missing assets fall back to stills.

7

Mobile pass, then polish

- Ask for the mobile pass (1080p sources, responsive type, drawer nav), then tune copy, colors, and section backdrops.

THE KICKOFF PROMPT (COPY THIS)

Paste this into Claude Code, filling the three blanks. It encodes every guardrail at once.

```
I want to build another scroll-cinema site like the ones in this  
repo. First read CLAUDE.md.
```

KICKOFF PROMPT

```
Branch: work on <your-branch>. Do NOT create new branches; commit  
and push directly. Do NOT touch or restructure existing routes.
```

```
Concept: <one hero object or scene, e.g. 'a private-jet charter,  
a night-to-day flight scrubbed by scroll'>.
```

```
Copy the closest finished site (RIFT is the most complete).  
Propose a brand name, /route, subdomain key, accent color and  
font - let me veto. Then scaffold: components/<name>/,  
lib/<name>-assets.ts with EMPTY url slots, app/<name>/page.tsx,  
one line in middleware SUBDOMAIN_ROUTES, one line in the  
app-wrapper allowlist. Build must stay green; commit + push  
after each step.
```

```
Then give me the exact Higgsfield recipes for the source assets.  
I'll generate them; you pull, upscale to 4K, and wire them in.
```

Why each line is there

- 'Read CLAUDE.md' loads the whole playbook into Claude's head.
- 'Don't touch existing routes' protects the five live sites.
- 'EMPTY url slots' means it compiles before any asset exists.
- 'You pull, upscale, wire' splits the work correctly: you generate, Claude integrates.

THE ASSET PIPELINE

Five source assets per site. Everything else (reassembly, zoom-out, theme washes) is derived or free.

ASSET	MODEL + KEY SETTINGS
Hero still	Nano Banana, 16:9, Count 4, Enhance OFF. Product small, centered, big negative space, dark studio.
Second still	Nano Banana, ref = hero. The 'end state' (exploded / arrived). Same camera + light.
Transform clip	Kling 3.0, start = hero, end = second still, 5s, Enhance OFF, Audio OFF, 1080p.
Camera-move clip	Kling 3.0, SINGLE start frame (no end). Orbit or push-in. One motion only.
Macro / detail clip	Kling 3.0, single start = hero, push into a detail. Reverse it free for zoom-out.

Generate clips at 1080p first (cheap). Upscale only the keepers to 4K with Topaz (Claude does this for you). Reverse clips cost nothing.

Non-negotiable prompt principles

- Enhance OFF, always - it adds drift, zoom and new lights.
- Generous negative space in stills so motion never clips the frame.
- Lock the camera and light in words: 'zero camera movement', 'lighting stays exactly the same, no new lights'.
- TWO frames for a transformation; ONE frame for a camera move. Same image as start AND end stalls Kling.
- One motion per clip. For products add 'rigid, undistorted, holds its exact shape, no warping'.
- Chain for seamless: each clip's start = the previous clip's last frame.
- Negatives every time: no text, no logos, no people, no hands, no warping.

REUSABLE CLIP PROMPTS

Transformation (two frames)

Kling 3.0 - start = hero still, end = second still - 5s -
Enhance OFF, Audio OFF, 1080p.
Prompt: The <product> smoothly <deconstructs / opens / takes apart> into its components and they drift apart. Zero camera movement, lighting stays exactly the same. Rigid, undistorted, holds its exact shape, no warping.
Negatives: no text, no logos, no people, no warping, no new lights.

TRANSFORM

Camera move (single frame)

Kling 3.0 - single start = hero (NO end frame) - 5-10s -
Enhance OFF, Audio OFF, 1080p.
Prompt: Smooth cinematic <360 orbit / slow push-in> around the <product>. Slow, steady, locked radius. The object holds its exact rigid shape, lighting stays consistent, no warping.
Negatives: no text, no logos, no people, no warping, no shake.

CAMERA MOVE

Bridging a cut (make two clips meet)

If clip A ends rotated and clip B starts front-on, screenshot A's last frame, upload it as B's start, and set B's end = the next clip's start image. Both boundaries become seamless.

Kling 3.0 - start = screenshot of previous clip's LAST frame, end = next clip's start image - 5s - Enhance OFF, Audio OFF.
Prompt: continue the motion from the start frame smoothly into the end frame, one continuous camera move, rigid and undistorted.

BRIDGE

THE HARD-WON FIXES

Every wall hit while building these, and the fix - so you can name the problem to Claude and it knows the answer.

'It looks blurry'

The capture canvas defaulted to 300x150. It must be sized from video.videoWidth on the first frame. Claude's RIFT engine already does this.

'It plays like a slideshow'

Something scrubbed video.currentTime. Capture frames first, paint from the image sequence. Never decode on scroll.

'It crashes / lags on my phone'

Too many 4K clips decoding at once. Mobile must use the 1080p source at device width; only desktop loads the 4K master.

'The object just spawns / pops into existence'

Two-frame clip with the object absent in the start and present in the end - the model fades it in. Give it somewhere to come FROM: have it enter from a frame edge, or hide the change behind a cloud / whip-pan, and add negatives: 'no fading in, no materializing, no teleporting, no ghosting'.

'There's a hole between two clips'

Either reverse an existing clip to fill it (free), or generate one bridge clip chained start->end across the gap.

'Enhance keeps changing my shot'

Turn Enhance OFF. It rewrites the prompt and adds drift, zoom and lights. This single setting causes most 'why did it do that' moments.

THEME, MOBILE, AND SHIPPING

Theme

- Sample the accent from the footage's key light - warm champagne car, cool titanium watch, crimson drink, volt-green sneaker, gold sunrise jet.
- Keep the animation's center bright; darken only the edges for nav/text. Add a brightness/contrast/saturate boost so the product pops.
- Lighter scrim on text beats so the motion shows through behind the copy.

Mobile conventions

- overflow-x-hidden on main; headlines scale text-5xl -> md:text-8xl.
- Kickers shrink and hide their flanking hairlines; nav collapses to a wordmark + drawer.

Shipping & viewing

- npm run build must pass, then commit + push. Subdomains map in middleware (watch->/oscilla, vanta->/vanta, etc.).
- Preview deployments have NO subdomain - view a new site at <preview-url>/<name> (e.g. /meridian), not the root.

The loop, distilled

```
concept -> kickoff prompt -> scaffold (empty slots, green build)
-> you generate asset -> Claude pulls + upscales + wires
-> build + push -> repeat per clip -> mobile pass -> ship
```

THE WHOLE LOOP



NOW GO MAKE ONE.

Pick a hero object. Render one beautiful motion. Let scroll drive it.
The engine is already written - your job is the concept and the prompts.

Built something with this? Tag me.

@uibyjonah

Jonah's Web Strategy / Parallel / Edition 1.0 / 2025
Scroll-cinema field guide. Made with Claude Code.